

Pinnacle Studio Ultimate Events Pro Deluxe 11

Your Own Personal Video Studio

Good camcorders and digital cameras at reasonable prices are common these days, and that means that budding film and art students are on the lookout for good video compiling and editing software to go with them. Pinnacle comes into the picture here with Pinnacle Studio Ultimate Events Pro Deluxe 11.

The package is huge, and comes with a PCI FireWire expansion card for your PC. There's also a chroma cloth to make keying and mask creation a lot easier. The installation is fairly simple—first install Studio Plus and then the upgrade to Ultimate.

The Ultimate version gives you three main plugins—proDAD VitaScene, BIAS SoundSoap and StageTools MovingPicture. It also gives you the ability to work with 5.1 audio streams.

The bundle features a huge collection of transition effects for scenes, and there are also loads of sounds

provided in appropriate categories. Each of the components—sound, video, and text—are placed in different timelines, so handling all of them is very

simple. There's support for online video hosts like Yahoo! Video and Studio Online.

The package comes with a fat, highly-detailed user manual, which even has tips on how to get your hard drive prepared for the large amounts of data required

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



during video editing by tweaking and optimising transfer rates.

At first, Pinnacle Studio Pro Deluxe 11 seems like a very sophisticated package, but its abundance of features is presented in a very friendly interface—you don't have to be a trained professional to use them. At Rs 17,900 for the internal PCI package, the decision to buy it is a little difficult, but if you're a student getting into the film industry or running a small business, it's a must-have.

Specifications

Included in Ultimate: BIAS SoundSoap, proDAD VitaScene, StageTools MovingPicture; Supports Dolby 5.1 encoding and HD video; Package contents: Green Screen, microphone, PCI FireWire interface card, manual

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Price: Rs 17,900 (Internal PCI), Rs 19,900 (External PCI)

Samsung ML-1630

Beauty Is Skin-deep

Take one look at the Samsung ML-1630, and you'll be forced to think: is this really a printer? Samsung has paid great attention to the aesthetics of this mono laser printer by giving it a glossy, piano-black finish and no sharp edges. Just 12.2 cm tall, it's smaller than many inkjets out there.

The control panel is rather simple—there are two touch-sensitive buttons for Power and Cancel. The visual indicators become visible during operation in the form of a blue LED display that displays the total number of pages printed. The input tray is hidden, and can be opened using a mechanical button. It holds 100 sheets, but the output tray holds just 30.

The printer has issues handling paper—almost every time we printed, the first page emerged crumpled. For a multi-page document, it took 17 seconds for the first page and around 4 for every page thereafter. In our standard test print, it could print at 6.5 pages per minute. Print quality is decent—sharp edges, proper gray tones and small point sizes were all printed well.

The printer features only the USB interface. Nothing comes bundled

RATINGS	
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Performance	★★★★★
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except for the standard drivers and a manual. It comes with a toner cartridge that's good for 1,000 pages, but a replacement cartridge (for 2000 sheets) is the standard one used with this printer. Backed with a one-year warranty, the Samsung ML-1630 is priced at Rs 11,490—too high a price for top-notch aesthetics with sub-par performance.

Specifications

Resolution: 1200 x 600 dpi (hardware); Input tray: 100 sheets; Output tray: 30 sheets; Buffer: 8 MB; Dimensions: 33 (W) x 37.6 (D) x 12.2 (H) cm; Weight: 6.3 kg

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Price: Rs 11,490